



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Driving under Supervision Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

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1.0 Introduction

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) Driving and Maintenance Courses provide for the requisite training, assessment and authorization for members to operate service vehicles in the designated class and type. These courses support the Force's efforts to effectively manage crime, public order and public safety in keeping with its mandate.

Aside from the requirements to operate in ways that promote professionalism and public confidence, members have a duty to operate service vehicles within the confines of the Road Traffic Act and related legislations. Additionally, there is the constant need to exercise a duty of care for all road users and passengers, as well as the need to safeguard vehicles and related assets. The JCF driver-training is therefore designed to build knowledge, competence and confidence in each participant. One such course is the Qualifying Driving and Maintenance Course.

The Qualifying Driving and Maintenance Course is comprised of four components, three of which are conducted under instruction at the Department of Driver Training. These components are the Assessment, Theory and Practical Driving. The fourth component, Driving under Supervision, is done on-the-job and is managed by the respective members' Commanding Officer. This supervised on-the-job probationary period is envisaged to further hone the member's capability and confidence as a safe and competent driver, enhance knowledge of the geographic outlay of the respective division/locale, and ultimately reduce the potential for accidents and other incidents.

This Policy and Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) seeks to build in and standardize the operationalization of the probationary component of the Qualifying Driving and Maintenance Course. The probationary period will commence at the end of the practical training component and conducted within the Formation the member is assigned.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this Policy and SOP is to provide standardized guidelines for the management of the probationary driving component of the JCF's Qualifying Driving and Maintenance Course.

3.0 Scope

This policy and SOP shall apply to all members of the JCF and its auxiliary and concerns the probationary period of the Qualifying, Driving and Maintenance Course. It does not apply to the following:

- i. Upgrading Driving and Maintenance Course
- ii. Remedial Driving and Maintenance Course

It should be read in conjunction with the Department of Driver Training Manual which sets out the Assessment, Theoretical and Practical Driver Training components.

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4.0 Definitions

For the purpose of this Policy and SOP, the following definitions shall apply:

- 4.1 **Probationer Driver** – participant on Qualifying Driving and Maintenance Course who has successfully completed the practical training and is not yet certified or promulgated in the Weekly Force Orders.
- 4.2 **Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet** – assessment sheet designed to score or grade participants driving competence while they are driving under supervision (see **Appendix 1**).
- 4.3 **Supervisor** – a member not below the rank of corporal with a minimum of not less than four (4) years' service and is an active Force Driver.
- 4.4 **Senior Force Driver** – same as **Supervisor** as defined at **section 4.3**.
- 4.5 **Service Vehicle** – all government owned vehicles assigned to the JCF of Classes A, B and C as well as motor cycles. This excludes boats, watercrafts, motorized bicycles, front-end loaders, articulated vehicles as well as those that from time to time may be rented, hired or leased.
- 4.6 **Tier One Drivers** - are driver training participants who demonstrate a high level of competence.
- 4.7 **Tier Two Drivers** - are driver training participants who demonstrate a moderate level of competence.
- 4.8 **Tier Three Drivers** - are driver training participants who demonstrate fair level of driving, irrespective of their driving experience.

5.0 Roles and Responsibilities

The following summarises key roles and responsibilities:

- 5.1 **Assistant Commissioner of Police, National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ)**
It shall be the responsibility of the Assistant Commissioner of Police, NPCJ to:
 - 5.1.1 on completion of the Driver training, issue Driver Certification to successful driver training participants; and
 - 5.1.2 Submit names of successful driver training participants to Deputy Commissioner of Police, Administration for promulgation in Force Orders.
- 5.2 **Commanding Officer**
It shall be the responsibility of the Commanding Officer to:

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- 5.2.1 ensure systems are in place to facilitate the supervised probationary driver assessment; and
- 5.2.2 forward reports and recommendations to the Superintendent of Police i/c Department of Driver Training within seven (7) days of completion of Probationer Driver training.

5.3 Superintendent of Police i/c Department of Driver Training

The Superintendent of Police i/c Department of Driver Training shall be responsible to:

- 5.3.1 submit the name(s) of Probationer Driver and class vehicle permitted to operate to the respective Commanding Officer at the end of the Practical Training component;
- 5.3.2 review Probationer Driver's Assessment Sheet and recommendations on receipt from Commanding Officer; and
- 5.3.3 submit names of successful drivers to Assistant Commissioner of Police NPCJ for submission to Deputy Commissioner of Police, Administration for promulgation in Force Orders.

5.4 Transport Manager

The Transport Manager shall be responsible to:

- 5.4.1 ensure that the Probationer Driver is supervised by a Senior Force Driver as defined in this policy;
- 5.4.2 ensure the *Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet* is completed by the respective supervisors and returned after each assessment;
- 5.4.3 liaise with the duty sub-officers to ensure Probationer Drivers are facilitated with duties to allow for assessment of their driving as required by policy; and
- 5.4.4 submit the completed *Probationer Driver's Assessment Sheet* as well as a completed *Progress Report (as at Appendix 2)* along with recommendation(s) to the Commanding Officer on a weekly basis or earlier where necessary.

5.5 Supervisor

The supervisor shall:

- 5.5.1 during the Probationer's driving assignments, accompany him/her and conduct assessment of their performance;
- 5.5.2 fill out the *Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet* each time a Probationer Driver is being assessed;

- 5.5.3 report to the Transport Manager as soon as practicable, any deficiency observed on the part of the Probationer Driver, that will pose a risk in respect to his/her driving function/responsibility; and make recommendation(s) for appropriate action to address the deficiencies; and
- 5.5.4 submit completed *Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet* to the Transport Manager at the end of each driving assignment.

6.0 Policy Statements

It is the policy of the JCF that:

- 6.1 All members having successfully completed the Practical Training component of the Qualifying Driving and Maintenance Course shall successfully complete the prescribed probation period driving under supervision prior to being certified as Force Drivers.
- 6.2 The probation period for driving under supervision shall be as follows:
 - i. **Tier 1 Drivers:** 16 hours in no less than 14 days and no more than 30 days
 - ii. **Tier 2 Drivers:** 32 hours in no less than 14 days and no more than 60 days
 - iii. **Tier 3 Drivers:** 48 hours in no less than 21 days and no more than 90 days
- 6.3 On all driving assignments, Probationer Drivers must be supervised and assessed by a Senior Force Driver.
- 6.4 On completion of the prescribed period driving under supervision, the names of successful participants shall be promulgated in Force Orders as Force Drivers with the corresponding Class of vehicle permitted to operate.
- 6.5 The Commissioner of Police shall have the authority to waive the requirements for the probationary period of driving under supervision in special circumstances as will be determined by his/her office.

7.0 Standard Operating Procedures

The following procedures shall apply:

- 7.1 On notification from the Superintendent i/c Department of Driver Training of the member's successful completion of the Practical Training component, the respective Formation's Transport Manager shall inform the member upon his/her resumption of normal duties, of the prescribed probation period driving under supervision, and the details of his/her responsibility for becoming a Force driver.

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- 7.2 The Duty Sub-Officer shall collaborate with the Transport Manager to ensure that the duties of the Probationer Driver are arranged in a manner that facilitates driving under supervision in accordance with **section 6** of this policy.
- 7.3 The Probationer Drivers must have their valid driver's license in their possession at all times during driving assignments, and shall adhere to the driving standards as outlined in the Driver Training Manual. They shall not be allowed to drive any service vehicle other than the Class vehicle trained to operate.
- 7.4 The sub-officer facilitating the supervision shall ensure the appropriate section of the *Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet* is filled out and signed on each occasion a Probationer Driver completes his/her driving assignment.
- 7.5 The supervisor shall submit the completed *Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet* to the Transport Manager **within 24 hours** of the Probationer's driving assignments.
- 7.6 The Transport Manager shall assess the progress of each Probationer Driver and intervene to address any deficiency(ies) detected.
- 7.7 The Transport Manager shall submit the *Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet* on a weekly basis, or earlier where necessary, to the Commanding Officer with the appropriate comments or recommendations.
- 7.8 At the end of the prescribed probation period driving under supervision, the Transport Manager shall submit the *Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet* along with the *Progress Report* with recommendation(s) to the Commanding Officer.
- 7.9 The Commanding Officer shall submit the *Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet* along with his/her report and recommendation(s) to the Superintendent i/c Department of Driver Training, National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ).
- 7.10 On receipt, of the *Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet*, the Superintendent i/c Department of Driver Training shall review the Probationer Driver's overall assessment and where he/she was successful, issue such driver with the appropriate certification from the NPCJ.
- 7.11 Thereafter, the Superintendent i/c Department of Driver Training shall submit the name and the class vehicle for which the Probationer Driver is qualified to drive to the Assistant Commissioner of Police i/c NPCJ for onward submission to the Deputy Commissioner of Police i/c Administration Portfolio for promulgation in Force Orders.

N.B. The member is designated a Force Driver when his/her name is promulgated in Force Orders.

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7.12 **Failure to successfully complete the prescribed probation period driving under supervision**

- 7.12.1 During the probationer's assessment phase, where the supervisor observes any deficiency on the part of the Probationer Driver, it must be immediately brought to his/her attention along with the required corrective measure(s). If the Probationer Driver fails, neglects, refuses or is unable to adhere to the corrective measure(s) and is deemed to be at risk, the supervisor shall immediately stop him/her from driving.
- 7.12.2 The supervisor shall, **within 24 hours**, submit a report outlining the issues, along with the completed *Probationer Driver Assessment Sheet* to the Transport Manager.
- 7.12.3 The Transport Manager shall forward the report along with his recommendation to the Commanding Officer within **24 hours** after receipt.
- 7.12.4 After reviewing the report, the Commanding Officer, shall determine if the Probationer Driver should be returned to driving under supervision or withdrawn from the driver training.
- 7.12.5 If for any reason a Probationer Driver is discontinued from driving practices a report must be forwarded through the Commanding Officer to the Superintendent i/c Department of Driver Training who will officially withdraw that member from the course.
- 7.12.6 Where a member having been withdrawn from a driver training wishes to be re-admitted to a driver training programme, he/she may re-apply within a period of **no less than three (3) months** after being withdrawn, with the recommendation of his/her Commanding Officer.

8.0 **Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles**

- 8.1 Department of Driver Training Manual
- 8.2 JCF Police Public Interaction Policy and Standard Operating Procedures
- 8.3 Road Code
- 8.4 Road Traffic Act

9.0 **Relevant Records and Forms**

- 9.1 Probationer Driver under Supervision Assessment Sheet
- 9.2 Progress Report
- 9.3 Station Diary/Station Records Management System

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JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
PROBATIONER DRIVER UNDER SUPERVISION ASSESSMENT SHEET

DIVISION/FORMATION: _____		DRIVER NAME: _____		REG#: _____	RANK: _____
CONTACT NUMBER: (876) _____		OFFICE NUMBER (876) _____		EMAIL: _____	
NAME OF SUPERVISOR: _____			REG# _____	RANK: _____	
TRAINING COURSE PERIOD: FROM _____			TO: _____	TYPE OF UNIT DRIVEN _____	
PRACTICAL TIERING: ONE (1) ☐		TWO (2) ☐		THREE (3) ☐	

[illegible]

PROBATIONER DRIVER UNDER SUPERVISION ASSESSMENT SHEET

The following table should serve as a guide to for supervisor to assess the probationary driver

CONS. #	GENERAL ROAD TEST CRITERIA		
1	ROAD CODE	14	POSITIONING & TURNING
2	GENERAL MAINTENANCE	15	JUDGEMENT WHEN OVERTAKING
3	STARTING PROCEDURE	16	USE OF THE ROUNDABOUT
4	CONCENTRATION & ROAD OBSERVATION	17	STEERING CONTROL
5	USE OF MIRRORS	18	CORNERING
6	USE OF CLUTCH	19	REVERSING
7	GEAR CHANGING	20	MOVING OFF THE GRADIENT
8	PULLING OUT & FOLLOWING	21	USE OF THE DUAL CARRIAGE WAY
9	SPEED MANAGEMENT	22	DRIVING COMFORT FOR PASSENGER(S)
10	USE OF SIGNALS	23	EMERGENCY STOPPING
11	KNOWLEDGE OF THE USE OF THE ROAD	24	STOPPING
12	USE OF BRAKE & STALLING	25	PARKING
13	REGARDS FOR OTHER ROAD USERS	26	EMERGENCY RESPONSE DRIVING

RATING SCALE	
A – EXCELLENT (85% - 100%)	B – GOOD (65% - 84%)
C – SATISFACTORY (45% - 64%)	D – USATISFACTORY (0% - 44%)

GENERAL COMMENT_____

Transport Manager’s Signature_____

DATE:_____

Appendix 2



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
PROBATIONER DRIVER'S PROGRESS REPORT

Probationer Driver:

Name: _____ Rank _____ Reg No. _____

Tier 1 [] Tier 2 [] Tier 3 []

Period of Probationary Driver Training:

From: _____ To: _____

Level of Performance:

Below standard [] Satisfactory [] Good [] Excellent []

General Comment

Append additional notes where necessary

Recommendation:

Progressing well [] Extend Probation period [] Withdraw from Course []

Name of Transport Manager _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____